Islamic Studies / Ethics

Course Summary — Topics, Concepts, Qur'anic Verses & Hadiths (Document pages 12–54)

Source: *Islamist_course_pack.pdf* (Course Code SS1007) — compiled by Umair Gulzar & Qurat ul Ain Fatima

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1. Why Do We Need Religion? (pp. 12–16)

An introspective opening essay challenging the reader to examine faith consciously rather than as inherited habit — do we truly understand what we recite and believe, or are we repeating what we were taught?

The essay then poses the question **"Who is behind existence, order and purpose?"** through seven wonders of nature, each ending in a rhetorical question about a Designer:

- **01 – A Universe Beyond Imagination:** the scale of the observable universe (2+ trillion galaxies).
- **02 – A Beginning:** why is there something rather than nothing (the Big Bang).
- **03 – The Atom:** the ordered, invisible architecture of matter.
- **04 – A Seed That Knows How to Become a Tree:** germination and biological information.
- **05 – From a Tiny Beginning to a Thinking Human:** embryology and neural development.
- **06 – The Heart You Never Have to Command:** the autonomic heartbeat.
- **07 – The Epiglottis:** the silent, precise reflex protecting the airway.

The Question the Qur'an Asks — after presenting these wonders, the notes cite:

> *"Were they created by nothing, or are they themselves the creators?"*
>
> Qur'an 52:35 (Surah at-Tur)

2. Introduction to Religion (pp. 17–21)

Etymology

- **Religion** — from Old French *"Religiun"* ("respect for what is sacred") and Latin *"Religionem"* ("reverence for the gods").
- **Mazhab** — Urdu/Arabic word meaning "a way to go", "a path", "a method" — in Arabic used for "point of view"/"school of thought", not exactly "religion".
- **Deen** — the Arabic word actually used in the Qur'an and Hadith for "religion"; also means retaliation, recompense, requital, commandment, judgment.

> *(Allah is) "The Master of the Day of Judgment."*
>
> Referenced as an example of the word 'Deen' in the Qur'an (Surah al-Fatihah 1:4)

Other Qur'anic words used in the sense of religion: *Millah*, *Siraat*, *Minhaaj*, *Shir'ah* — but "Deen" is preferred because it indicates requital/recompense of deeds in the afterlife.

Definitions of Religion — Western Scholars

- **Edward Burnett Tylor (1832–1917)**, *Primitive Culture*: "The belief in spiritual being."

- **David Émile Durkheim (1858–1917)**, *The Elementary Forms of the Religious Life*: "Unified system of beliefs and practices relative to sacred things."
- **William James (1842–1910)**, *The Varieties of Religious Experience*: "The feelings, acts and experiences of individual men in their solitude, whatever they may consider the divine."

Analysis: Western thought tends to treat religion as a private, individual, belief-centred matter. The Divine/Eastern (Islamic) perspective instead treats religion as a complete, practical, and collective code of life — roughly 90% practice-oriented rather than purely doctrinal.

Divine Perspective

> *"Religion is a complete code of life set and sent down by the Creator, the Lord (God), through His messengers from time to time to guide His slaves (Mankind & Jinn) to success in life and the afterlife."*

Need for Religion

- **Demand of Nature (Fitrah):** despite humanity's natural love of freedom, 80–85% of the world's population still voluntarily affiliates with some religion — pointing to an innate, created disposition to believe.
- **The God Gene hypothesis** — Dean H. Hamer, *The God Gene: How Faith Is Hardwired into Our Genes* (2004): proposes the VMAT2 gene may predispose humans toward spiritual/mystical experience.
- **Andrew Newberg**, *How God Changes Your Brain* (2009): neuroscientific research linking prayer/meditation to brain activity, supporting a neurobiological basis for spirituality.
- **Craving of the Mind:** the enduring human questions — "From where?" "To where?" "Why?"

Classification of Religions

Of roughly 9,000 world religions (including tribal religions), they are classified as:

- **Revealed religions** — claim a divine scripture: Judaism, Christianity, Islam.
- **Non-revealed religions** — no claimed divine scripture, though some have sacred/holy books.

Six Theological Worldviews

- **Atheism** — denies the existence of God/any divine being; universe held to be self-existent.
- **Agnosticism** — uncertainty about God's existence (term coined by Thomas Huxley, 19th c.).
- **Deism** — a Creator exists but does not intervene or reveal further guidance (e.g., Voltaire, Jefferson).
- **Pantheism** — God and the universe are identical (e.g., Spinoza, strands of Hinduism).
- **Monotheism** — one all-powerful, transcendent God who is Creator and Sustainer (Judaism, Christianity, Islam).
- **Polytheism** — belief in multiple deities (e.g., ancient Greece, Rome, Egypt).

3. Introduction to Islam (pp. 22–28)

Etymology & Definition

“Islam” derives from the Arabic root *Salama*, meaning “Peace” and “Safeness”; it literally also means “Obedience”, “Submission”, and “Surrender”.

> *A complete code of life revealed by Allah (the Creator, the Owner, the Sustainer & the Lord) to His Prophets & Messengers (from Adam AS to Muhammad (PBUH)) to guide His slaves (Mankind & Jinn) to success in life and the afterlife.*

Important Note — Islam vs Other Religions

Unlike other religions (often limited to birth, marriage and death rituals), Islam is a complete, systematic code covering worship, family, social dealings, economics, politics and law, as well as everyday routines like eating, drinking, sleeping and dressing.

> *And truly, this is the revelation from the Lord of all worlds. The trustworthy spirit (Jibraeel) brought it down, upon your heart, so that you may become one of the warners, in plain Arabic language.*
>
> Qur'an 26:192–195

The Subject & Objective of Islam

> *I did not create mankind and Jinn except for the purpose that they should worship Me.*
>
> Qur'an 51:56 (Adh-Dhariyat)

Objective: to provide complete guidance leading mankind and Jinn to success in life and the afterlife — defined as safe removal from Hellfire and entrance into Paradise.

> *So, whoever is safely removed from the Fire of Hell and admitted to Paradise, he succeeded indeed. And the worldly life is not but the goods of delusion.*
>
> Qur'an 3:185

Hadith-e-Jibraeel (Sahih Muslim: 93)

Hazrat Umar (RA) narrates that Jibraeel (AS) came in the form of a man and questioned the Prophet (PBUH) before the companions in the Prophet's Mosque in Madinah.

1) Islam — Five Pillars

- **Shahada** — declaring the oneness of God and the Prophethood of Muhammad (PBUH).
- **Salah** — performing the five daily prayers.
- **Zakat** — giving alms to the poor and needy.
- **Sawm** — fasting during the month of Ramadan.
- **Hajj** — pilgrimage to Mecca for those who are able.

2) Iman — Six Articles of Faith

- Belief in Allah
- His angels
- His books
- His messengers
- The Day of Judgment
- Predestination (Qadar) — that good and bad are decreed by Allah

3) Ihsan (Excellence in Worship)

> *To worship Allah as if you see Him, and even though you do not see Him, you should know that He sees you.*
>
> Sahih Muslim: 93

The Structure of Islam (outline)

- **I. Foundations:** Tawheed (Oneness of God) · Risalah (Prophethood) · Akhirah (Hereafter)
- **II. Religious Structure** — A) Beliefs (Iman, 6 articles); B) Practices (Ibadah, 5 pillars); C) Sources of Law: Qur'an, Sunnah, Ijma (Consensus), Qiyas (Analogy)
- **III. Islamic Systems** — A) Social System (human dignity, family, marriage/divorce, gender roles, rights of neighbours/orphans); B) Ethical System (Halal vs Haram, integrity, justice/'Adl, accountability before God); C) Political System (Shura/consultation, Caliphate, governance under Sharia, justice & law enforcement); D) Economic System (Zakat, prohibition of Riba, Islamic banking, fair trade & charity)

Why Islam? — Convert Case Studies

The notes reference modern conversion stories (e.g., Lauren Booth, Kristiane Backer, Alfie Best Jr., and the book/series “Why I Chose Islam”), plus the “Towards Eternity” YouTube channel, as case studies for reflecting on why people embrace Islam.

Finality of Islam

> *Truly, the religion with Allah is Islam.*
>
> Qur'an 3:19

> *O you who believe, be afraid of Allah as He deserves to be feared, and let not yourself die save as Muslims.*
>
> Qur'an 3:102

> *And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted from him, and he, in the hereafter, will be among the losers.*
>
> Qur'an 3:85

> *Those who disbelieve and die as disbelievers, an earth-full of gold even shall never be accepted from any of them... They are the ones for whom there is a painful punishment, and for them there are no helpers.*
>
> Qur'an 3:91

> *I swear by the One who holds the life of Muhammad, any of the Jew or Christian from among the people who comes to know about me, and then dies without having faith in what I have been sent with (Islam), he will definitely be among the Hell members.*
>
> Hadith — Abu Huraira (RA); Sahih Muslim: 386

4. The Belief System of Islam — Iman (pp. 29–39)

Definition of Iman

Linguistically from the root *a-m-n*, meaning security, affirmation, trust. Technically: firm conviction and acceptance of what was revealed to Prophet Muhammad ●.

> *Iman is to believe with the heart, confess with the tongue, and act with the limbs.*

> *Indeed, those who have believed and done righteous deeds — they will have the Gardens of Paradise as a lodging.*
>
> Qur'an 18:107

The Six Articles of Faith (Arkan al-Iman) are derived from the Qur'an and the Hadith of Jibraeel:

- 1) Iman bi-Tawhid — Belief in the Oneness of Allah
- 2) Iman bil-Mala'ikah — Belief in the Angels
- 3) Iman bil-Kutub — Belief in the Books
- 4) Iman bir-Rusul — Belief in the Prophets
- 5) Iman bil-Yawm al-Akhira — Belief in the Last Day
- 6) Iman bil-Qadar — Belief in Divine Decree

5. Tawhid — Oneness of God (pp. 30–34)

> *Those who truly fear Allah, among His servants, who know Allah.*

Surah al-Ikhlas is described in Hadith as equal to one-third of the Qur'an because it encapsulates the essence of Tawhid:

> *Proclaim: He is Allah, Who is the One. Allah is the Transcendent of all, the Protector and Far-Superior to all. He has not begotten any, nor is He begotten. Nor is there anyone equal to Him.*
>
> Qur'an 112:1–4 (Surah al-Ikhlas); Hadith reference — Sahih al-Bukhari: 5013

> *And We did not send any Messenger before you, but We revealed to him (saying): none has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah), so worship Me (Alone).*
>
> Qur'an 21:25

> *And verily, We have sent among every Ummah (nation) a Messenger (proclaiming): Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid (or keep away from) Taghut.*
>
> Qur'an 16:36

Three Types of Tawhid

- **Rububiyah (Lordship):** Allah alone caused all things to exist from nothing (*creation ex nihilo*) and sustains the universe without need. Rooted in the word “Rabb” (Lord) — cf. Surah al-Fatihah, v.1, and Surah an-Naml, verses 60–65.
- **Uluhiyyah (Worship):** only Allah is worthy of worship (*ibadah*) — “complete love accompanied by complete submission”, covering supplication, reliance, obedience.
- **Asmaa was-Sifaat (Names & Attributes):** Allah's names/attributes must be affirmed exactly as He and the Prophet (PBUH) described them — without distortion, without new additions,

without likening them to creation, and without human beings being elevated to His level (e.g., the examples of Al-Hayy/the Ever-Living and Al-Qayyum/the Self-Subsisting).

> *And I (Allah) did not create the jinn and men except that they should worship Me (alone).*
>
> Qur'an 51:56 (Surah adh-Dhariyat)

6. Shirk — The Unforgivable Sin (pp. 35–38)

> *And indeed, it has been revealed to you (O Muhammad), as it was to those before you: If you join others in worship with Allah, (then) surely (all) your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers.*
>
> Qur'an 39:65 (Az-Zumar)

> *Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but He forgives what is less than that to whomever He wills...*
>
> Qur'an 4:48 (An-Nisa)

The notes explain that shirk before repentance can still be forgiven, but dying upon shirk is unforgivable. This is illustrated by the Qur'anic account of Prophet Isa (AS) disowning any claim that he told people to worship him or his mother.

Repentance Before Death — Hadith

A Sahih Hadith recounts an old man confessing every sin to the Prophet (PBUH), who reassures him that sincere Shahada plus turning to righteous deeds brings Allah's forgiveness, turning bad deeds into good ones.

Types of Shirk

- **Major Shirk (Shirk Akbar):** ascribing Lordship, Divinity or Divine Names/Attributes to other than Allah — e.g., belief in another creator/sustainer, absolute obedience to other than Allah against the religion of the Messengers, loving a created being as Allah is loved, or believing someone besides Allah knows the unseen or bestows mercy as He does.
- **Minor Shirk (Shirk Asghar):** lesser acts that can lead to major shirk — e.g., relying on amulets/charms for protection, or excessive veneration of people/things.

> *What I fear most about you is the minor shirk... Ar-riya (showing off). Allah will say on the Day of Judgment when He pays people for their deeds: Go to those for whom you performed riya in the world and see if you find any reward with them.*
>
> Hadith — Musnad Ahmad bin Hanbal: 57

> *...they feared men as they fear Allah, or with even greater fear.*
>
> Qur'an 4:77 (An-Nisa)

The Concept of Ownership

Everything belongs to Allah alone; humans are only temporary caretakers. Illustrated by the **Battle of Hunain**, where early Muslim overconfidence in their numbers led to a setback, and Allah reminded them that victory comes only from Him:

> *Indeed, Allah has given you believers' victory on many battlefields, even at the Battle of Hunain when you took pride in your great numbers, but they proved of no advantage to you.*

The earth, despite its vastness, seemed to close in on you, and then you turned back in retreat.

Qur'an 9:25 (At-Tawbah)

7. Belief in the Angels — Iman bil-Mala'ikah (pp. 40–41)

> *The Messenger has believed in what was revealed to him from his Lord, and so have the believers... They believe in Allah, His angels, His books, and His messengers...*
>
> Qur'an 2:285 (al-Baqarah)

> *The angels were created from light...*
>
> Hadith — Sahih Muslim: 2996

> *They do not disobey Allah in what He commands them but do what they are commanded.*
>
> Qur'an 66:6 (At-Tahrim)

> *They exalt Him night and day and do not slacken.*
>
> Qur'an 21:20 (Al-Anbiya)

The Four Archangels

- **Jibra'il (AS)** — the angel of revelation; delivered Allah's messages to the Prophets. (Qur'an 81:19–21)
- **Mikail (AS)** — responsible for sustenance and natural forces such as rain and vegetation.
- **Israfil (AS)** — will blow the Trumpet to signal the end of the world and the Day of Judgment.
- **Izrail (AS)** — the Angel of Death, tasked with removing the souls of the deceased.

8. Belief in the Books — Iman bil-Kutub (pp. 42–44)

- **The Tawrah** — revealed to Prophet Musa (AS) for the Children of Israel; contained commandments, legal rulings, spiritual teachings.
- **The Zabur (Psalms)** — revealed to Prophet Dawud (AS); focused on praise, worship and spiritual wisdom rather than law.
- **The Injeel (Gospel)** — revealed to Prophet 'Isa (AS); confirmed the Tawrah and emphasised mercy, compassion and love. The notes distinguish the original Injeel from the four later Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John), written by human authors.
- **The Qur'an** — the final, complete, and eternally preserved revelation to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), confirming and correcting distortions in earlier scriptures.

> *Indeed, We sent down the Torah, in which was guidance and light. The prophets who submitted [to Allah] judged by it for the Jews...*
>
> Qur'an 5:44

> *And to David We gave the Zabur.*
>
> Qur'an 4:163 (An-Nisa)

> *And We sent, following in their footsteps, Jesus, the son of Mary, confirming that which came before him in the Torah; and We gave him the Gospel, in which was guidance and light.*
>
> Qur'an 5:46

> *He has revealed to you the Book in truth, confirming what was before it. And He revealed the Torah and the Gospel before as guidance for mankind, and He revealed the Criterion (the Qur'an).*
>
> Qur'an 3:3

> *Indeed, it is We who sent down the Reminder (the Qur'an), and indeed, We will be its Guardian.*
>
> Qur'an 15:9

Theological point: believing in all the divine books means acknowledging their divine origin and role in history — not following earlier scriptures as they exist today. The Qur'an is held to abrogate and supersede all previous revelations, remaining the final, fully preserved criterion.

9. Belief in the Prophets — Iman bir-Rusul (pp. 45–47)

Prophethood (*Nubuwwah*) is the divine system through which Allah guides humanity via chosen Prophets (Nabi) and Messengers (Rasul).

Mission of the Prophets

- Teach people about Allah's Oneness (Tawhid).
- Deliver divine laws (Shariah).
- Warn people against evil and disbelief.
- Give glad tidings of Paradise to believers and warn disbelievers of Hell.

> *[We sent] messengers as bringers of good tidings and warners so that mankind will have no argument against Allah after the messengers.*
>
> Qur'an 4:165

Infallibility (Ismah) of the Prophets

Prophets are divinely protected from major and minor sins, though they retain free will; any apparent “mistake” (e.g., Prophet Adam eating from the tree) is understood as human forgetfulness, not rebellion.

> *Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah often.*
>
> Qur'an 33:21 (Al-Ahzab)

> *And We had already taken a promise from Adam before, but he forgot; and We found not in him determination [to disobey].*
>
> Qur'an 20:115 (Taha)

Miracles (Mu'jizat)

- **Prophet Ibrahim (AS):** the fire became cool and safe when he was thrown into it — “We said, O fire, be coolness and safety upon Abraham.” (Qur'an 21:69)
- **Prophet Musa (AS):** the sea split for him and his people — “Then We inspired to Moses, Strike the sea with your staff, and it parted, and each portion was like a great towering mountain.” (Qur'an 26:63)

Finality of Prophethood (Khatm an-Nubuwwah)

> *Muhammad is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets.*
>
> Qur'an 33:40 (Al-Ahzab)

Three supporting Hadiths cited:

- “There will arise thirty great liars in my Ummah, each of them claiming to be a Prophet. But I am the last of the Prophets, there is no Prophet after me.” — *Sunan Abu Dawood, Sahih: 4252*
- “The example of me and the Prophets before me is like a man who built a beautiful house... but one brick was missing. I am that last brick, and I am the last of the Prophets.” — *Sahih al-Bukhari: 3535*
- “You (Ali) are to me as Harun was to Musa, except that there is no Prophet after me.” — *Sahih Muslim: 2404*

10. Belief in the Day of Judgment — Iman bil-Yawm al-Akhira (pp. 48–50)

> *Indeed, the Hour is coming — there is no doubt about it — and Allah will resurrect those in the graves.*
>
> Qur'an 22:7 (Al-Hajj)

Barzakh — The Intermediate Phase

Death marks the soul's separation from the body; the soul then enters Barzakh, a realm between the physical world and the Day of Judgment, where it may experience comfort or punishment.

> *And behind them is a barrier (Barzakh) until the Day they are resurrected.*
>
> Qur'an 23:100 (Al-Mu'minun)

> *When a believer is buried, two angels come and ask... If he answers correctly, his grave is expanded and filled with light. If not, the grave is tight and filled with fire... He hears the beat of their sandals as they leave, and then he is questioned.*
>
> Hadith — Musnad Ahmad / Sahih al-Bukhari

Phases of the Day of Judgment (Yawm al-Qiyamah)

- **The Trumpet (Sur):** blown by the angel Israfil, causing all life to cease, then blown again after 40 years to resurrect the dead. “And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and the earth will fall dead, except whom Allah wills.” (Qur'an 39:68, Az-Zumar)
- **The Great Intercession (Ash-Shafa'ah al-'Uzma):** after a long wait, people seek intercession from Prophet after Prophet until reaching Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), who will intercede to begin the Reckoning. (Jami' at-Tirmidhi)

Stages of the Reckoning (Hisab)

- **1) Distribution of the Book of Deeds** — the righteous receive it in their right hand; the wicked in their left hand or from behind their back. “Then as for he who is given his record in his right hand, he will be judged with an easy account... But as for he who is given his record behind his back, he will cry out for destruction.” (Qur'an 84:7–12, Al-Inshiqaq)
- **2) Weighing of Deeds (Mizan)** — “And We shall set up the scales of justice for the Day of Resurrection, so that no soul is treated unjustly in anything.” (Qur'an 21:47, Al-Anbiya)
- **3) Witnesses** — angels who recorded deeds, Prophets testifying for/against their nations, and even a person's own body parts. “That Day, their tongues, hands, and feet will testify against them about what they used to do.” (Qur'an 24:24, An-Nur)

Both Paradise (Jannah) and Hell (Jahannam) are real, eternal destinations. The full journey — Barzakh, Qiyamah, Reckoning, and final destination — underscores each person's accountability and the hope for Allah's mercy through sincere faith and righteous action.

11. Belief in Divine Decree — Iman bil-Qadar (pp. 51–52)

Belief in **Qadr** (divine destiny) and **Qadha** (divine execution/decree) — everything in the universe, good or bad, happens according to Allah's perfect knowledge and will.

Qadr — Divine Destiny

> *Indeed, We have created all things with Qadr (predestination).*
>
> Qur'an 54:49 (Al-Qamar)

> *Allah has set a measure for everything.*
>
> Qur'an 65:3 (At-Talaq)

Qadha — Divine Execution

Allah brings about events according to what He has already destined; human actions remain within our free will even though Allah's knowledge encompasses them.

> *Everyone will find easy that for which he was created.*
>
> Hadith — Sahih al-Bukhari

Dua and Destiny

Some aspects of destiny are fixed (definite) while others are conditional and can change through sincere prayer and repentance.

> *Nothing repels destiny except dua, and nothing increases lifespan except righteousness.*
>
> Hadith (cited in the notes)

12. Introduction to the Worship System — Ibadah (pp. 53–54)

Worship (*'ibadah*) in Islam is not confined to ritual performance; it extends to every aspect of life lived in accordance with divine guidance. Its purpose is to cultivate continuous God-consciousness (*taqwa*), spiritual discipline and communal unity.

The formal structure of worship is expressed through the **Five Pillars of Islam**:

- Shahadah — Declaration of Faith
- Salah — Prayer
- Zakah — Almsgiving
- Sawm — Fasting (during Ramadan)
- Hajj — Pilgrimage to Mecca

Beyond these obligatory acts, Islam also encourages voluntary worship (*nawafil*), ethical conduct, and social responsibility as integral expressions of faith.

The Shahadah (Declaration of Faith)

The Shahadah is the foundational pillar of Islam — the essential entry point into the faith, affirming the central tenet of Tawhid:

> *I bear witness that there is no Almighty God but Allah, and I bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.*

Theological Significance

- **Divine Unity (Tawhid):** recognising Allah as the sole Creator, Sustainer, and Ruler of the universe, with no partner in His divinity or attributes.
- **Prophethood (Risalah):** acknowledging Muhammad (PBUH) as the final messenger who conveyed Allah's final revelation (the Qur'an) to humanity.

The Shahadah functions as a personal covenant with Allah and a public affirmation of faith, implying acceptance of Allah's guidance, commitment to living by Islamic principles, and entrance into the global Muslim community (Ummah).

Ritual & Legal Role

- **Conversion to Islam:** sincerely uttering the Shahadah, with understanding and belief, is the sole requirement to become a Muslim.
- **Daily Worship:** the Shahadah is recited multiple times throughout the five daily prayers.
- **Social & Legal Recognition:** in Islamic jurisprudence (fiqh), a person's status as a Muslim is formally recognised through their articulation of the Shahadah.

Note: The course pack continues beyond this point (p. 55 onward) into Salah and the remaining Four Pillars, and other topics through page 126. This summary covers pages 12–54 as requested.

Compiled as a study aid from the uploaded course pack. Arabic script quotations were represented here by their English translations for readability; the original Arabic text and page-image formatting can be found in the source PDF.